JAMES HOUSTON

CYBERSECURITY | INFORMATION SECURITY | SECURITY OPERATIONS

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

CompTIA Security+ certified cybersecurity student with a 4.0 GPA and professional IT support experience at ECPI University. Hands-on experience building a Windows enterprise security lab with Active Directory, Wazuh SIEM, Sysmon, and Proxmox. Technical training in security monitoring, incident investigation, vulnerability assessment, technical documentation, identity and access management, network security, Linux administration, and cloud security.

CERTIFICATION

CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701)

EDUCATION

ECPI University | B.S., Information and Cybersecurity Operations (Cybersecurity Track)

Expected April 2027 | GPA: 4.00

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Operations: Wazuh SIEM, Sysmon, Windows Event Logs, Wireshark/tshark, log analysis, incident response labs, vulnerability assessment, Nmap, malware analysis, CVE research, technical documentation

Identity & Endpoint Security: Active Directory, Microsoft Entra ID, Microsoft 365, MFA, Conditional Access, privileged access/PIM, Group Policy, Windows Server, Windows 11

Networking & Systems: Cisco routing and switching, VLANs, OSPF, ACLs, Cisco ASA, DNS, DHCP, TCP/IP, Linux/Ubuntu, Proxmox

Cloud & Automation: AWS, AWS IAM, Azure, Google Cloud, EC2, S3, CloudFormation, Python, PowerShell, Bash, Git/GitHub, security analytics

RELEVANT IT EXPERIENCE

Library IT Assistant (Federal Work Study) | ECPI University

Richmond, VA | November 2025 - Present

- Diagnose and resolve routine Windows workstation, account access, printing, and connectivity issues for students and faculty.
- Reimage and prepare classroom and lab computers; connect monitors, workstations, peripheral devices, and cabling.
- Explain technical problems, troubleshooting steps, and next steps clearly to technical and nontechnical users; escalate unresolved issues with relevant details.

SECURITY OPERATIONS PROJECT

Enterprise Security Operations Homelab

Proxmox | Active Directory | Windows Server/11 | Wazuh | Sysmon | Kali Linux

- Built a virtualized enterprise environment with a Windows Server domain controller, domain-joined Windows 11 endpoint, and Linux-based Wazuh security monitoring server.
- Deployed Wazuh agents and Sysmon to centralize Windows security events and endpoint telemetry for monitoring and investigation practice.
- Maintain detailed GitHub documentation covering lab architecture, VM/network configurations, tool deployments, troubleshooting, and investigation workflows to create reproducible technical records.
- Research disclosed vulnerabilities (CVEs), vendor security advisories, and mitigation guidance to identify lab-relevant risks and plan controlled validation using a separate Kali Linux testing environment.

SELECTED CYBERSECURITY & TECHNICAL LABS

Threat analysis and incident response: Used Wireshark/tshark, Windows logs, running processes, and network connections to investigate suspicious activity; practiced malware triage using strings, strace, and tcpdump, with NIST-informed reporting.

Identity and server security: Configured Active Directory, Group Policy, DNS/DHCP, Entra ID, MFA, Conditional Access, and privileged-access scenarios; practiced hybrid identity with Entra Connect and IdFix.

Network and Linux security: Configured VLANs, OSPF, ACLs, Cisco ASA firewall rules, and NAT/PAT; administered Windows and Linux systems and practiced network security troubleshooting.

Scripting, cloud, and risk management: Applied Python, K-Means, DBSCAN, PCA, and Isolation Forest in technical labs; planned an AWS cloud migration with CI/CD, budgeting, risk assessment, and stakeholder responsibilities.

RELEVANT COURSEWORK

Cybersecurity & analysis: Principles of Cybersecurity with AI; Advanced Cybersecurity with AI and Lab; AI/Machine Learning; Statistics; Ethical Hacking (in progress)

Networking: Introduction to Networking; Network Protocols and Services; Introduction to Routing and Switching and Lab; Intermediate Routing and Switching; Network Routing and Switching Lab

Systems & identity: Windows Client and Server and Lab; Advanced Windows Server and Lab; Linux Administration; Advanced Linux Administration and Lab; Microsoft 365 Administration

Programming & infrastructure: Introduction to Python Programming and Lab; Network Scripting; Computer Configuration I; Introduction to Operating Systems; Introduction to Computing

Cloud & project delivery: Introduction to Cloud Solutions and Lab; AWS Academy Cloud Foundations; Introduction to DevOps and Project Management

CUSTOMER SERVICE & LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Retail & Food Service | Assistant Manager, Shift Leader & Associate

2015 - 2018

· Earned frequent customer compliments for attentive service, clear communication, and effective resolution of concerns.

· Advanced quickly into shift leader and assistant manager positions through strong performance, reliability, and customer service.

· Supported daily operations, coached team members, managed customer escalations, and coordinated priorities in fast-paced environments.

ADDITIONAL WORK EXPERIENCE

Amazon Fulfillment Center | Warehouse Associate

2018 - 2022; 2024 - Present

· Maintain operational accuracy and follow safety and security procedures in a high-volume environment while balancing work and school.

United States Postal Service | Mail Carrier

2021 - 2023

· Handled sensitive mail and customer information with discretion, addressed delivery concerns, and managed time-sensitive routes independently.

Family-Owned E-Commerce Business | Administrative Assistant

2017 - 2020 (approx.)

· Managed orders, inventory, and product listings across Amazon, eBay, and Poshmark, including item photography and descriptions.

· Researched products and competitor pricing, sourced merchandise from retailers and suppliers, and tracked sales, expenses, and profits.

· Inspected and prepared inventory, packaged and shipped orders, and resolved customer inquiries, returns, refunds, and complaints.

· Troubleshot routine computer, network, printer, shipping software, and marketplace seller account issues to support daily operations.